THEORY SHEET

Linking Words & Relative Clauses

Although / Though / Even Though vs. Despite / In Spite Of

Both express a **contrast** — something happened even though you wouldn't expect it. But they work differently in how you build the sentence.

although / even though

Followed by a **sentence with a subject + verb**.
Although it rained *a lot, we enjoyed our holiday.*
Even though she was *tired, she couldn't sleep.*
~~*Although the bad weather, we went out.*~~ — wrong: no verb after "although"

despite / in spite of

Followed by a **noun** or **-ing form** (NOT a subject + verb).
Despite the rain*, we enjoyed our holiday.*
In spite of being *very tired, she couldn't sleep.*
~~*Despite she was tired, she continued.*~~ — wrong: clause after "despite"

Quick test: Look at what follows. Is there a **subject + verb** (e.g., "she was tired")? → use *although / even though*. Is there just a **noun** or **-ing form** (e.g., "the rain" / "being tired")? → use *despite / in spite of*.

As vs. Like

like + noun

Means **"similar to"** — a comparison (not the real thing).
He acted ***like*** *a clown in class today. (= he is NOT a clown)*
That house looks ***like*** *a palace.*

as + noun

Means **"in the role of"** — the actual function or job.
He performs ***as*** *a clown at children's parties. (= he IS a clown)*
She works ***as*** *a nurse at the hospital.*

as + subject + verb

Means **"in the same way as"** when followed by a sentence.
You should do it ***as*** *I showed you.*

Relative Clauses — Who, Which, That

who — Refers to **people**. *The student* ***who*** *sits next to me is from Germany.*

which — Refers to **things**. *The book* ***which*** *I borrowed was very helpful.*

that — Can replace *who* or *which* — but **ONLY when the information is essential** to identify who/what you mean (see "defining" below).

Defining — the information tells you *which person or thing* you mean. It is essential. No commas. *That* is OK.
The woman ***who/that*** *lives next door is a doctor.* — Which woman? The one next door.

Non-defining — the information is *extra*. You already know who/what is meant. Use commas. *That* is NOT OK.
*My neighbour****, who*** *has a lot of dogs****,*** *is a great guy.* — We already know which neighbour.
~~*My neighbour,* ***that*** *has a lot of dogs, is a great guy.*~~ — wrong: no "that" with commas

"Which" for a whole idea (NOT "what" or "that"):
He failed the exam, ***which*** *surprised everyone.*
~~*He failed the exam,* ***what*** *surprised everyone.*~~ — wrong
~~*He failed the exam,* ***that*** *surprised everyone.*~~ — wrong

Watch Out! — Common Mistakes by Language Background

If you speak Dutch...

hoewel / ondanks: Dutch has the same split, but many Dutch speakers mix them up in English.
~~*Although the rain, we went out.*~~
Despite the rain, we went out.
Although it rained, we went out.

"wat" ≠ "what": Dutch *"wat"* = English **which** (not "what") when referring back to a whole idea.
~~*He quit his job, what surprised me.*~~
He quit his job, which surprised me.

"als" does too much: Dutch *als* = as, like, and if. English keeps these separate.
She works ***as*** *a nurse. (= her job)*
He acts ***like*** *a child. (= not really a child)*

If you speak Spanish...

"aunque" covers everything: English splits this into *although* (+ sentence) and *despite* (+ noun / -ing). Since Spanish uses *aunque* for both, you may pick the wrong English word.
Although it was raining... (sentence after "although")
Despite the rain... (noun after "despite")
~~*Despite it was raining...*~~ ~~*Although the rain...*~~

"que" is not always "that": In Spanish, *que* works for everything. English splits it: *who* (people), *which* (things).
~~*My teacher, that is very kind, helped me.*~~
My teacher, who is very kind, helped me.

"como" splits into two:
He works ***as*** *a waiter. (= his job)*
He eats ***like*** *a horse. (= comparison)*

If you speak Polish...

chociaż / mimo że: The split exists in Polish too, but *despite* in English is simpler — just add a noun or -ing form.
~~*Despite she was late, we waited.*~~
Despite being late, we waited.
Although she was late, we waited.

który/która/które → who/which: English is simpler (no gender), but has a rule Polish doesn't: no *that* between commas.
~~*Warsaw, that is the capital, is large.*~~
Warsaw, which is the capital, is large.

jak / jako: Polish *jak* covers both "as" and "like."
He works ***as*** *a chef. (= his job)*
He cooks ***like*** *a chef. (= not really a chef)*

Conditionals — Types 0, 1, 2 & 3

Conditional Types at a Glance

Type	Use	If-part	Result part	Example
Type 0	General truths, facts	if + **present simple**	**present simple**	*If you heat water to 100°C, it boils.* *If you press this button, the door opens.*
Type 1	Real future possibility	if + **present simple**	**will** + verb	*If it rains tomorrow, I will stay home.* *If you study hard, you will pass.*
Type 2	Imaginary present / future	if + **past simple**	**would** + verb	*If I had more time, I would travel more.* *If I were rich, I would buy a boat.*
Type 3	Imaginary past (too late now)	if + **past perfect** (had + done/gone/been...)	**would have** + past form (e.g., gone, studied, been)	*If she had studied harder, she would have passed.* *If I had known, I would have helped.*

Key Rules

No "will" in the if-part

*If it **rains** tomorrow, we will cancel.*
~~*If it **will rain** tomorrow, we will cancel.*~~

Type 2: use "were," not "was"

*If I **were** you, I would accept the offer.* — standard / formal
"If I *was* you..." is common in spoken English but "were" is preferred in writing.

No "would" in the if-part

*If I **had known**, I would have come.* (Type 3)
~~*If I **would have known**, I would have come.*~~

Quick Comparison — Same Situation, Different Types

Type 1 (real)

*If she **studies** hard, she **will pass** the exam.* — It's possible and likely.

Type 2 (imaginary)

*If she **studied** hard, she **would pass** the exam.* — She's not studying hard (but imagine if she did).
If my grandma had wheels, she would be a bike. — Yes, that's a Type 2 conditional!

Type 3 (past, too late)

*If she **had studied** hard, she **would have passed** the exam.* — She didn't study. The exam is over.

Mixed Conditionals

Sometimes the if-clause and result clause refer to **different time frames**.

Past → Present
(Type 3 if + Type 2 result)

*If I **had accepted** that job, I **would be** living in London now.*
The past decision affects the present situation.

Present → Past
(Type 2 if + Type 3 result)

*If I **spoke** French, I **would have applied** for that job last month.*
Something that is always true about you affected a past opportunity.

Watch Out! — Common Mistakes by Language Background

If you speak Dutch...

Don't put "zou" in the if-part:
~~*If I would win the lottery, I would buy a house.*~~
If I won the lottery, I would buy a house.

Type 2 and 3 feel the same: Dutch uses similar forms for both.
*Now: If I **had** more money, I would travel.*
*Back then: If I **had had** more money, I would have travelled.*
Ask yourself: am I imagining now, or regretting the past?

If you speak Spanish...

Don't translate the subjunctive directly: Focus on the English pattern.
*Type 2: If I **had** time... (past simple)*
*Type 3: If I **had had** time... (past perfect)*

"would had" does not exist:
~~*If she had called, I would had come.*~~
*If she had called, I would **have** come.*

No "will" in the if-part:
~~*If it will rain, we will stay inside.*~~
If it rains, we will stay inside.

If you speak Polish...

"gdyby" covers Type 2 AND 3: English forces you to choose — this is a new distinction.
*Now: If I **knew** the answer... (past simple)*
*Back then: If I **had known** the answer... (past perfect)*
Ask: am I imagining now, or regretting the past?

Word order is stricter:
If I had a car, I would drive to work.
I would drive to work if I had a car.
~~*A car if I had, to work I would drive.*~~

EXERCISES

Linking Words & Relative Clauses

Warm-up — Spot the Mistake

*Each sentence contains **one** grammar mistake. Find the error and write the corrected sentence on the line.*

1. *Although the rain, we went out.*

   _____

2. *My teacher, that is very kind, helped me.*

   _____

3. *If I would be rich, I would buy a house.*

   _____

Section A — Choose the Right Connector

Can you tell the difference between although (+ subject + verb) and despite (+ noun or -ing)?
*Fill in **although, even though, despite,** or **in spite of**. The last two items test **as** vs. **like**.*

1. _____ the heavy traffic, we arrived at the university on time.
2. _____ she had revised all week, she still found the exam difficult.
3. He kept working on his thesis _____ being completely exhausted.
4. _____ the course was challenging, most students passed with good grades.
5. _____ all the preparation, the group presentation didn't go as planned.
6. She finished the project on time _____ having very little support from her team.
7. He works _____ a teaching assistant at the Faculty of Education. (as / like)
8. Stop acting _____ a child and take responsibility for your project. (as / like)

Section B — Relative Pronouns

*Fill in **who, which,** or **that**. Add commas where they are needed. Remember: you cannot use "that" when the information is just extra detail (with commas).*

1. The professor _____ teaches Academic Writing is retiring next year.
2. Utrecht _____ is the fourth-largest city in the Netherlands has a beautiful old centre.
3. The student _____ submitted the essay late received a lower grade.
4. My internship supervisor _____ has worked in the field for 20 years gave me great advice.
5. The laptop _____ I bought last month has already broken down.
6. She didn't pass the resit, _____ really surprised everyone.
7. The building _____ houses the university library was built in the 19th century.
8. He decided to drop the minor, _____ I thought was a mistake.

Section C — Defining or Non-Defining?

*Write **D** (defining — the info tells you which person/thing) or **ND** (non-defining — the info is just extra) next to each sentence. For ND sentences: add the missing commas and cross out "that" if it has been used incorrectly.*

1. _____ Students who submit their work late will lose marks.
2. _____ Professor de Vries who has been teaching here for 30 years announced his retirement.
3. _____ The course that I enjoyed most was Intercultural Communication.
4. _____ The Jaarbeurs that hosts many events is next to Utrecht Centraal station.
5. _____ The cafe that is next to the university is always crowded.
6. _____ The final presentation that we had been preparing for weeks went really well.

EXERCISES

Conditionals

Section D — Identify the Type

*Read each sentence and write **Type 0, 1, 2,** or **3** in the blank.*

1. _____ If you heat ice, it melts.
2. _____ If she finishes her essay today, she will have time to revise it tomorrow.
3. _____ If I spoke fluent Japanese, I would apply for that job in Tokyo.
4. _____ If they had left earlier, they would have caught the train.
5. _____ If it rains this afternoon, we will cancel the barbecue.
6. _____ If I were the prime minister, I would invest more in education.

Section E — Complete the Sentence

Put the verb in brackets into the correct form. Refer to your theory sheet if needed.

1. If you _____ (mix) red and blue, you _____ (get) purple.
2. If she _____ (not/hurry), she _____ (miss) the bus.
3. We _____ (go) to the beach if the weather _____ (be) nice tomorrow.
4. If I _____ (have) more free time, I _____ (learn) to play the guitar.
5. She _____ (travel) the world if she _____ (not/have) so many responsibilities.
6. If he _____ (study) harder, he _____ (pass) the exam last week.
7. I _____ (not/be) late yesterday if I _____ (set) my alarm.
8. If I _____ (be) you, I _____ (accept) that internship offer.
9. If she _____ (not/miss) the deadline last month, she _____ (not/be) in trouble now. (mixed)
10. If we _____ (leave) now, we _____ (arrive) before dark.

Section F — Write the Conditional

Read the situation. Write a full conditional sentence using the type shown.

1. SITUATION (TYPE 3)
You didn't bring an umbrella. You got completely soaked.

_____

_____

2. SITUATION (TYPE 2)
You want to study abroad, but you don't have enough savings.

_____

_____

3. SITUATION (TYPE 1)
Your friend might call you tonight. If so, you'll tell them the news.

_____

_____

4. SITUATION (TYPE 3)
You didn't check the timetable. You went to the wrong classroom.

_____

_____

EXERCISES

Mixed Practice — All Three Topics

Section G — Error Correction

*Each sentence contains **one** error. Underline the error and write the **corrected word or phrase** on the line.*

1. Although the bad weather, the outdoor event was a success.
Correction: _____

2. Despite she was very nervous, she gave an excellent presentation.
Correction: _____

3. He works like a freelance designer for several companies.
Correction: _____

4. The new library, that was built last year, has already become very popular.
Correction: _____

5. He failed his driving test, what really disappointed his parents.
Correction: _____

6. The student which won the essay competition is in my class.
Correction: _____

7. If I will see her tomorrow, I will give her your message.
Correction: _____

8. If I would have known about the meeting, I would have attended.
Correction: _____

9. If you will heat water to 100 degrees, it boils.
Correction: _____

10. If I was you, I would talk to the teacher about it.
Correction: _____

Section H — Sentence Transformation

Rewrite each sentence using the word or structure given in brackets. The meaning must stay the same.

1. Although it was expensive, she bought the textbook. (DESPITE)

_____

2. The man lives next door. He is a doctor. (WHO — one sentence)

_____

3. I didn't study for the test. I failed. (IF — Type 3 conditional)

_____

4. Despite being very tired, she finished the assignment. (EVEN THOUGH)

_____

5. The university is in the centre of town. It was founded in 1636. (WHICH — one sentence)

_____

6. She doesn't have a car. She takes the bus to work. (IF — Type 2 conditional)

_____

7. My roommate isn't a chef, but he cooks in the same way a professional would. (LIKE)

_____

8. He completed the project ahead of schedule. This impressed his supervisor. (WHICH — one sentence)

_____

Section I — Integrated Writing

*You are an HU student who has just been offered a six-month internship in Barcelona. Think about the decision, the challenges, and what might happen. Write **6 sentences** that include all of the following:*

- ☐ At least 1 sentence with **although** or **even though**
- ☐ At least 1 sentence with **despite** or **in spite of**
- ☐ At least 1 **defining** relative clause — tells you which person/thing (who/which/that, no commas)
- ☐ At least 1 **non-defining** relative clause — adds extra info (who/which + commas)
- ☐ At least 1 **Type 2** conditional (imaginary present/future — "If I had...")
- ☐ At least 1 **Type 3** conditional (imaginary past — "If I had known...")

ANSWER KEY

Week 6 Grammar Workout — Answers

Check your work. For Sections F and I, compare with the examples below — other correct versions are possible.

Warm-up — Spot the Mistake

1. Although the rain → **Despite** the rain (or: **Although it rained**)
2. My teacher, **that** → My teacher, **who** (no "that" with commas)
3. If I **would be** → If I **were** rich (no "would" in the if-part)

Section A — Choose the Connector

1. Despite / In spite of the heavy traffic
2. Although / Even though she had revised
3. despite / in spite of being exhausted
4. Although / Even though the course was
5. Despite / In spite of all the preparation
6. despite / in spite of having very little
7. as (he IS a teaching assistant)
8. like (not actually a child)

Section B — Relative Pronouns

1. who/that — defining, no commas
2. Utrecht**, which** is the fourth-largest...**,** has — ND, commas needed
3. who/that — defining, no commas
4. supervisor**, who** has worked...**,** gave — ND, commas needed
5. which/that — defining, no commas
6. resit**, which** really surprised — ND, "which" refers back to the whole idea
7. which/that — defining, no commas
8. minor**, which** I thought was — ND, "which" refers back to the whole idea

Section C — Defining or Non-Defining?

1. D — no changes needed
2. ND — Professor de Vries**,** who...**,** announced
3. D — no changes needed
4. ND — The Jaarbeurs**,** which...**,** is (that → which, add commas)
5. D — no changes needed
6. ND — presentation**,** which...**,** went (that → which, add commas — "the final" already tells us which one, so the clause is extra info)

Section D — Identify the Type

1. Type 0 **2.** Type 1 **3.** Type 2
4. Type 3 **5.** Type 1 **6.** Type 2

Section E — Complete the Sentence

1. mix / get (Type 0)
2. doesn't hurry / will miss (Type 1)
3. will go / is (Type 1)
4. had / would learn (Type 2)
5. would travel / didn't have (Type 2)
6. had studied / would have passed (Type 3)
7. wouldn't have been / had set (Type 3)
8. were / would accept (Type 2)
9. hadn't missed / wouldn't be (Mixed: past if-part + present result)
10. leave / will arrive (Type 1)

Section F — Example Answers

1. If I had brought an umbrella, I wouldn't have got soaked.
2. If I had enough savings, I would study abroad.
3. If my friend calls me tonight, I will tell them the news.
4. If I had checked the timetable, I wouldn't have gone to the wrong classroom.

Section G — Error Correction

1. Although → **Despite** (or: Although the bad weather → Although the weather was bad)
2. Despite → **Although** (or: Despite she was → Despite being)
3. like → **as** (he IS a freelance designer)
4. that → **which** (extra info with commas — use "which," not "that")
5. what → **which** ("which" refers back to the whole idea)
6. which → **who** (person, not thing)
7. will see → **see** (no "will" in the if-part)
8. would have known → **had known** (no "would" in the if-part)
9. will heat → **heat** (no "will" in the if-part, Type 0)
10. was → **were** (standard form in Type 2 "If I were you...")

Section H — Example Answers

1. Despite the high price / Despite it being expensive, she bought the textbook.
2. The man who lives next door is a doctor.
3. If I had studied for the test, I wouldn't have failed.
4. Even though she was very tired, she finished the assignment.
5. The university, which was founded in 1636, is in the centre of town.
6. If she had a car, she wouldn't take the bus to work.
7. My roommate cooks like a professional, but he isn't a chef.
8. He completed the project ahead of schedule, which impressed his supervisor.

Section I: No single correct answer. Check that each sentence uses the required grammar structure correctly. Look for: correct clause/phrase after although vs. despite, commas in non-defining clauses, correct verb forms in conditionals.